Even Keel

Our December 2026 link — what changes for you, in plain English

A proposal for discussion · CEA link · 26 weeks · code EK-26-H1

The short version

Five things to take away if you remember nothing else

35h	5	14	8 of 15	30 min
the contracted week, as now	**most days in a row**	**full weekends off a year**	**shift times you already work**	**off every closing shift**
no extra hours	up to 6 · today 7	today 10 · 7 in 26	7 new ones	Sundays: 45 min

Same hours, shorter closers, weekends off never more than five weeks apart, and one shift time most weeks.

Why the link has to change

Nobody is changing it for the sake of it

A new timetable in December 2026

More trains, at new times — the link has to follow them.

More of us on the link

It grows from 20 weeks to 26, so six more colleagues join it.

New staffing levels

At least 10 on a Sunday, and more at the open and the close. We also aim for 14 on a Saturday.

The ticket office in fixed pairs

Two early and two late, on the same shifts, every day.

The change is coming whatever we do — the question is which version we want.

Will I work more?

The first thing everyone asks

	Today	Even Keel
Contracted hours a week	35h	**35h**
Contracted days at work a week	4.20	**4.19**
Contracted days at work a year	219.0	**218.6**

No. The same 35-hour week on average and no more days; weeks run from 24h 30m to 41h 30m (today 25h 10m to 43h 50m), and two more of the days fall on a Saturday.

Will my basic pay change?

Basic pay follows your contracted hours

	Today	Even Keel
Contracted hours a week	35h	**35h**
Saturdays a year, at time and a quarter	26	**28**
Sunday overtime to share — each, a year	21	**20**

No. The same 35-hour week — plus about two more Saturdays at time and a quarter.

Will my shifts be longer?

Every closing shift gets shorter — the average goes up about two minutes

	Today	Even Keel
Weekday closer — starts 15:45, not 15:15	8h 40m	**8h 10m**
Saturday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:45	9h 10m	**8h 40m**
Sunday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:30	8h 55m	**8h 10m**
Longest shift anywhere	9h 10m	**9h 00m**
Average shift	8h 14m	**8h 16m**

Every closing shift is 30 to 45 minutes shorter; the longest early turn goes from 8h 30m to 9h 00m, and nothing runs over 9 hours.

Will I finish late more often?

5 more a year after 23:00 (44, today 39); 16 more at 22:00 or later (94, today 78)

	Today	Even Keel
Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year	39	**44**
Finishing at 22:00 or later — each, a year	78	**94**
Starting at 06:20 — each, a year	62	**60**
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	**14h 35m**

More people stay on after 22:00 under the December staffing; five more a year after 23:00, four to the Saturday close.

Will I know the times?

15 shift times in all — 8 of them you already work

You work these today (8)

- 06:20–14:00
- 06:20–14:20
- 06:20–14:50
- 07:15–15:45
- 11:00–19:30
- 14:00–22:30
- 14:30–22:00
- 15:15–23:55

New times (7)

Weekdays

- 14:45–22:30 — a new late, ending with the ticket office
- 15:45–23:55 — the closer, 30 minutes later than 15:15

Saturday

- 06:20–15:00 — a new early, 8h 40m
- 07:45–16:45 — a new early, 9 hours

Sunday

- 15:15–23:25 — the closer, 45 minutes later than 14:30
- 09:00–18:00 — a new early, 9 hours
- 14:30–22:30 — the ticket-office late

Fewer shift times than today (15, not 18) — and several of the new ones are shorter versions of today’s lates.

Rest and weekends

The biggest improvement over today

	Today	Even Keel
Full weekends off, about a year	10	**14**
Most days worked in a row	7 (up to 9)	**5 (up to 6)**
Rest-day breaks of two days or more	13 of 17	**22 of 26**
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	**14h 35m**
Weeks on one turn, no early–late switch	7 of 16	**18 of 21**

14 full weekends off a year, at most five weeks apart, and one shift time in 18 of 21 weeks.

Your 26 weeks at a glance

The green bars are the full weekends off; where you start is decided later



14 full weekends off a year, at most five weeks apart; blocks of earlies or lates up to 5 weeks, 12 if the cover weeks go the same way.

Booking leave

What 14 days of annual leave buys you, with Sundays off

	Today	Even Keel
Days off in a row — best place to book	30	**28**
Days off in a row — on average	23.4	**23.4**
Days off in a row — worst place	19	**20**
Leave for four full weeks off, at best	14	**15**

Best stretch 28 days, not 30; four full weeks off, Sunday to Saturday, costs 15 days' leave, not 14. Average the same, worst a day better.

More staff on the floor

More people rostered every day, at the open and the close

	Today	Even Keel
On duty on a weekday	11–12	**15**
On duty on a Saturday / Sunday	10 / 8	**14 / 10**
Fewest rostered on the floor	2	**3**
Avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	**0**

At least three rostered on the floor, and no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

The honest trade-offs

Nothing is free — here is what it costs

Seven new shift times to learn
Several of them are shorter versions of the lates you already work today.

Shifts about 2 minutes longer on average
That is what keeps days at work to 219 a year or fewer on the same 35 hours.

Four weeks off: 15 days' leave, not 14
Best 14-day stretch 28 days, not 30; average as today, worst a day better.

Two more Saturdays a year
28 a year each, today 26 — fourteen on a Saturday, shared across 26 lines.

A few more late finishes
44 a year each at 23:00 or later (today 39) — four to the close on a Saturday.

Still a proposal
Your views count before a link is chosen, and who goes on which line is not decided.

None of these is hidden: each one is on the full proposal sheet too.

At a glance

Today’s roster and Even Keel, side by side

	Today	Even Keel
Contracted hours a week	35h	**35h**
Contracted days at work a year	219.0	**218.6**
Average shift · longest shift	8h 14m · 9h 10m	**8h 16m · 9h 00m**
Closing shift: weekday · Saturday · Sunday	8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m	**8h 10m · 8h 40m · 8h 10m**
Full weekends off, about a year	10	**14**
Most days worked in a row	7 (up to 9)	**5 (up to 6)**
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	**14h 35m**
Different shift times	18	**15 (8 you know)**
On duty weekday · Saturday · Sunday	11–12 · 10 · 8	**15 · 14 · 10**
Avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	**0**

Same hours and days, shorter closers, more full weekends off.

What happens next

1. Look at the full proposal sheet — page 3 shows every week of the link
2. Tell us what worries you, even if it is small
3. Your feedback goes to the managers with the proposal